



CUDDLES CHILDMINDERS AND SCHOOLS

2026/2027 ACADEMIC SESSION HOME–SCHOOL PARTNERSHIP

BASIC ELEMENTARY LEVEL 6 (BEL 6)

Dear Parent,

We warmly welcome you and your child to the 2026/2027 Academic Session. By the grace of God, we trust that this will be a successful, purposeful and rewarding year of learning, growth and personal development.

BEL 6 is an important transition point in a learner's educational journey. At this stage, we expect learners to demonstrate greater independence, critical thinking, responsibility, resilience and readiness for the demands of higher basic education.

At CCMS, we believe that:

- **Every child is unique and should be nurtured, challenged and supported according to their individual strengths and needs.**
- **A strong home–school partnership is essential to helping every learner reach their potential.**
- **Learning should go beyond memorisation to include understanding, application, reasoning and problem-solving.**
- **Appropriate independence helps learners develop confidence, initiative and ownership of their learning.**
- **Clear expectations, consistent boundaries and meaningful consequences help children develop self-discipline.**
- **Feedback and correction should be used as opportunities for growth.**
- **Kindness does not mean the absence of accountability. Learners can be treated with compassion while still being held responsible for their choices.**
- **High but realistic expectations encourage learners to stretch themselves and take increasing ownership of their progress.**

We invite you to partner with us as we prepare your child for the next stage of their educational journey.

COGNITIVE & ACADEMIC EXPECTATIONS

By the end of BEL 6, learners should be able to demonstrate increasing confidence, accuracy and independence in the following areas:

Mathematics & Mathematical Reasoning

Learners should be able to:

- **Demonstrate fluency in addition, subtraction, multiplication and division involving whole numbers, fractions and decimals.**
- **Apply place value, estimation and rounding to increasingly complex problems.**
- **Solve multi-step problems and clearly explain the reasoning behind their solutions.**
- **Work confidently with fractions, including equivalent fractions, mixed numbers and improper fractions.**
- **Add, subtract, multiply and divide fractions at an appropriate level.**
- **Convert between fractions, decimals and percentages and apply these concepts to practical situations.**
- **Apply percentages to real-life problems.**
- **Understand and apply ratios, rates and proportion in age-appropriate contexts.**
- **Solve problems involving money, including discounts, profit and loss at an introductory level.**
- **Solve problems involving time, including elapsed time, timetables and schedules.**
- **Convert between common metric units of measurement.**
- **Solve problems involving length, mass, capacity, area and volume.**
- **Calculate the perimeter and area of common shapes.**
- **Identify and classify two- and three-dimensional shapes and their properties.**
- **Identify and classify different types of angles.**
- **Plot and interpret points using coordinates on a grid.**

- Read, interpret and construct tables, charts and graphs.
- Calculate and interpret the mean, median, mode and range of simple data sets.
- Recognise patterns and relationships between numbers and mathematical concepts.
- Apply introductory algebraic thinking, including the use of variables and simple expressions.
- Substitute simple values into expressions and solve basic equations.
- Use logical reasoning to solve puzzles and unfamiliar mathematical problems.
- Check answers independently and identify and correct errors.
- Select appropriate strategies and explain why a particular method is effective.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE, LITERACY & COMMUNICATION

Learners should be able to:

- Read a range of fiction, non-fiction, poetry and drama with fluency and appropriate expression.
- Demonstrate literal, inferential and evaluative comprehension.
- Identify main ideas, supporting details, themes, sequence, cause and effect.
- Draw conclusions and make predictions using evidence from texts.
- Compare and contrast characters, settings, themes, viewpoints and events.
- Identify an author's purpose and recognise different perspectives.
- Distinguish between fact, opinion, evidence and unsupported claims.
- Select relevant information from texts and summarise it accurately.
- Support answers, interpretations and opinions with appropriate evidence from texts.
- Use context, word roots, prefixes and suffixes to determine the meaning of unfamiliar words.
- Develop and apply an increasingly sophisticated vocabulary.

- Use dictionaries, thesauruses, encyclopaedias and appropriate digital reference sources effectively.
- Identify and correctly use major parts of speech.
- Apply grammar, punctuation, spelling and sentence structure accurately.
- Use synonyms, antonyms, homophones, prefixes and suffixes appropriately.
- Recognise and use figurative language, including similes, metaphors and personification.
- Organise ideas into coherent paragraphs using appropriate transitions.
- Write effectively for different purposes and audiences.
- Produce well-structured essays, narratives, reports, letters, research-based pieces and opinion writing.
- Plan, draft, revise, edit and present written work independently.
- Express an opinion clearly and support it with relevant reasons and evidence.
- Conduct age-appropriate research and distinguish relevant information from unnecessary information.
- Record and organise information from more than one source.
- Present information clearly through oral presentations, discussions and other appropriate formats.
- Participate respectfully in discussions and respond thoughtfully to different viewpoints.
- Ask relevant and meaningful questions.
- Communicate confidently and appropriately in both formal and informal situations.

CRITICAL THINKING, RESEARCH & PROBLEM-SOLVING

BEL 6 learners will be encouraged to:

- Think critically rather than accept information without question.
- Ask purposeful questions and investigate possible answers.
- Break complex tasks into manageable steps.
- Identify problems and propose practical solutions.

- Compare different solutions and evaluate their strengths and limitations.
- Use evidence to support conclusions.
- Recognise patterns, relationships and inconsistencies.
- Make predictions and test simple hypotheses.
- Consider alternative perspectives before reaching conclusions.
- Apply previously acquired knowledge to unfamiliar situations.
- Distinguish between reliable and unreliable information at an age-appropriate level.
- Reflect on mistakes and use feedback to improve future performance.
- Persevere when faced with challenging or unfamiliar tasks.
- Explain their thinking clearly rather than simply providing an answer.

DIGITAL & INFORMATION LITERACY

Learners will be guided to use technology responsibly as a tool for learning, research, creativity and communication.

They should be able to:

- Use a computer independently for common academic tasks.
- Create, save, organise and retrieve digital documents.
- Use age-appropriate educational applications and digital platforms.
- Conduct supervised online research.
- Identify basic indicators of trustworthy and unreliable information.
- Understand the importance of protecting personal information online.
- Use passwords and digital accounts responsibly.
- Demonstrate respectful and responsible digital communication.
- Understand the concept of a digital footprint.
- Recognise common online risks and know when to seek adult support.
- Use technology purposefully while maintaining healthy boundaries around screen use.

SELF-MANAGEMENT & LIFE SKILLS

Learners are expected to demonstrate increasing independence by being able to:

- **Manage personal hygiene and bathroom routines independently.**
- **Organise books, materials and personal belongings responsibly.**
- **Prepare for lessons and activities without constant reminders.**
- **Complete homework and assigned responsibilities with minimal assistance.**
- **Manage time and meet reasonable deadlines.**
- **Ask for help appropriately when genuinely needed.**
- **Take responsibility for mistakes and make appropriate efforts to correct them.**
- **Keep personal and shared spaces clean and organised.**
- **Follow routines and instructions with increasing independence.**
- **Work effectively both independently and as part of a team.**
- **Demonstrate initiative when appropriate.**
- **Take increasing ownership of their academic progress and behaviour.**

SOCIAL, EMOTIONAL & CHARACTER DEVELOPMENT

Learners will be encouraged to:

- **Demonstrate respect, empathy, kindness, honesty and fairness.**
- **Communicate feelings appropriately and constructively.**
- **Manage frustration, disappointment and conflict without inappropriate reactions.**
- **Listen to and consider other people's perspectives.**
- **Accept correction and constructive feedback maturely.**
- **Demonstrate resilience when faced with academic or personal challenges.**
- **Take responsibility for their decisions and behaviour.**
- **Recognise when their actions affect others.**
- **Make responsible choices even when influenced by peers.**
- **Demonstrate appropriate leadership and teamwork.**

- Recognise personal strengths and areas requiring improvement.
- Set realistic academic and personal goals.
- Reflect on progress and identify practical ways to improve.

THEME FOR THE SESSION

DISCIPLINE — MAKING WISE CHOICES FOR MY LIFE

At CCMS, we believe that discipline is not simply about following rules. It is about developing the self-control, responsibility, judgement and resilience needed to make wise choices—even when no one is watching.

Throughout the session, learners will be encouraged to:

- Understand that every choice has a consequence.
- Think before acting and consider how their decisions affect themselves and others.
- Develop self-control and manage impulsive reactions.
- Take ownership of their actions, decisions and mistakes.
- Follow instructions and routines with increasing independence.
- Make responsible choices when faced with distractions, temptation or peer pressure.
- Understand the difference between what I want to do and what I should do.
- Pause, think and choose an appropriate response when angry, frustrated or disappointed.
- Manage time responsibly and complete tasks within agreed deadlines.
- Develop the discipline to start, sustain and complete challenging tasks.
- Care for personal belongings, school resources and shared spaces.
- Accept correction and use feedback as a tool for improvement.
- Practise honesty, respect, kindness and fairness in everyday situations.
- Resolve disagreements through respectful communication rather than impulsive reactions.
- Develop healthy habits around learning, hygiene, organisation, rest and physical activity.

- Understand that greater independence comes with greater responsibility.
- Reflect on behaviour and identify what could be done differently next time.
- Set personal and academic goals and take practical steps towards achieving them.
- Recognise that discipline is not about perfection; it is about making better choices consistently.

OUR KEY MESSAGE

“I am responsible for my choices, my actions and the person I am becoming.”

THINK • CHOOSE • ACT • TAKE RESPONSIBILITY

Throughout the session, learners will be guided to understand that:

Wise choices build strong character, and strong character helps us direct our lives.

APPEARANCE & GROOMING

- **Uniforms:** Uniforms must be clean, neatly pressed and worn correctly each school day.
- **Girls:** Hair should be neatly braided, plaited or styled. Attachments, where used, must be black or brown only, neatly packed and school-appropriate. Beads and elaborate accessories are not permitted.
- **Boys:** Hair should be low, neat and maintained in modest, school-appropriate styles. Elaborate carvings, distracting designs or inappropriate partings are not permitted.
- **Footwear:** Black shoes and white socks are required on uniform days. Appropriate sportswear and sneakers should be worn on designated sports days.
- **Hygiene:** Fingernails must be short and clean. Jewellery and distracting accessories are not permitted, except small stud earrings for girls.

HEALTH, HYGIENE & NUTRITION

Learners should have breakfast at home before school.

Parents are encouraged to provide nutritious packed meals and healthy snacks, together with:

- **A clearly labelled water bottle.**
- **Personal cutlery where required.**
- **A suitable school bag.**

Parents should avoid sending unnecessary junk food, sugary drinks, chewing gum, candy or other items that may distract learners or conflict with the school's nutrition expectations.

Children who are visibly unwell should remain at home, and the school should be informed appropriately.

Any medication brought to school must be clearly labelled with the learner's name and dosage instructions and submitted according to the school's medication procedure.

SCHOOL HOURS & PUNCTUALITY

School Hours:

8:00 a.m. – 3:15 p.m., Monday to Friday, excluding public holidays, approved school closures, emergencies or national directives.

Punctuality is regarded as part of developing discipline, responsibility and respect for other people's time.

Pick-Up

A 15-minute grace period is allowed after closing time.

Late pick-up beyond 3:30 p.m. will attract a ~~R~~1,000 charge per additional hour or part thereof.

School Bus

Bus learners should arrive at the designated pickup point by 7:20 a.m.

The expected return time is approximately 4:30 p.m., subject to traffic and circumstances beyond the school's control.

PROJECTS & HOME LEARNING

Project work, whether individual or collaborative, is an important part of developing research, creativity, communication and problem-solving skills.

All assigned projects are compulsory and contribute to assessment.

Parents are encouraged to provide appropriate support and resources while allowing the learner to remain the primary thinker, researcher and creator of the work.

Homework will be assigned as appropriate, with a recommended maximum of 60 minutes every other day.

Homework contributes to cumulative assessment where applicable.

SCHOOL PROPERTY & PERSONAL BELONGINGS

Learners are expected to demonstrate responsibility for school resources and personal belongings.

- **All personal items should be clearly labelled.**
- **Learners should take reasonable care of their books, bags, bottles, lunch containers and other belongings.**
- **Learners must respect school property and the property of others.**
- **Parents may be required to replace or pay for school property damaged through deliberate or negligent behaviour.**
- **Lost property should be reported promptly.**

FEES & SCHOOL ADMINISTRATION

All school fees are expected to be paid according to the school's approved payment schedule.

Outstanding fees may result in temporary exclusion from school or the learner being sent home until the account is regularised, in accordance with school policy.

Staff Appreciation

CCMS discourages staff from receiving cash or personal gifts from parents in order to promote fairness, professionalism and equality.

Words of encouragement, constructive feedback and prayers are always appreciated.

PARTNERSHIP WITH PARENTS

We count on our valued parents and partners to:

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- Respond promptly to important school communications.
- Attend scheduled parent–teacher conferences and meetings.
- Respond promptly during emergencies.
- Participate in Having Involved Parent Days and other relevant school activities.
- Encourage reading, study and healthy routines at home.
- Reinforce appropriate behaviour and the values taught at school.
- Encourage independence rather than doing tasks for the learner.
- Inform the school of circumstances that may significantly affect their child's learning or well-being.
- Communicate concerns respectfully through the appropriate channels.

OUR COMMITMENT

BEL 6 is more than a preparation for the next class; it is a preparation for greater independence, greater responsibility and greater expectations.

We want our learners to move from asking:

“What am I supposed to do?”

to thinking:

“What is the wise choice, and what responsibility comes with it?”

At CCMS, we will teach, challenge, encourage, correct, support and celebrate each learner as they grow.

Together, we can nurture a learner who is academically prepared, intellectually curious, resilient, responsible, respectful and confident—a learner who understands that their choices today help shape the person they become tomorrow.

We look forward to a purposeful, productive and rewarding 2026/2027 Academic Session.

Warm regards,

Mrs. Bukola Odomo
Head of School

Cuddles Childminders and Schools (CCMS)

